

PROGRESSION · CANVAS · SERIES

waterfall

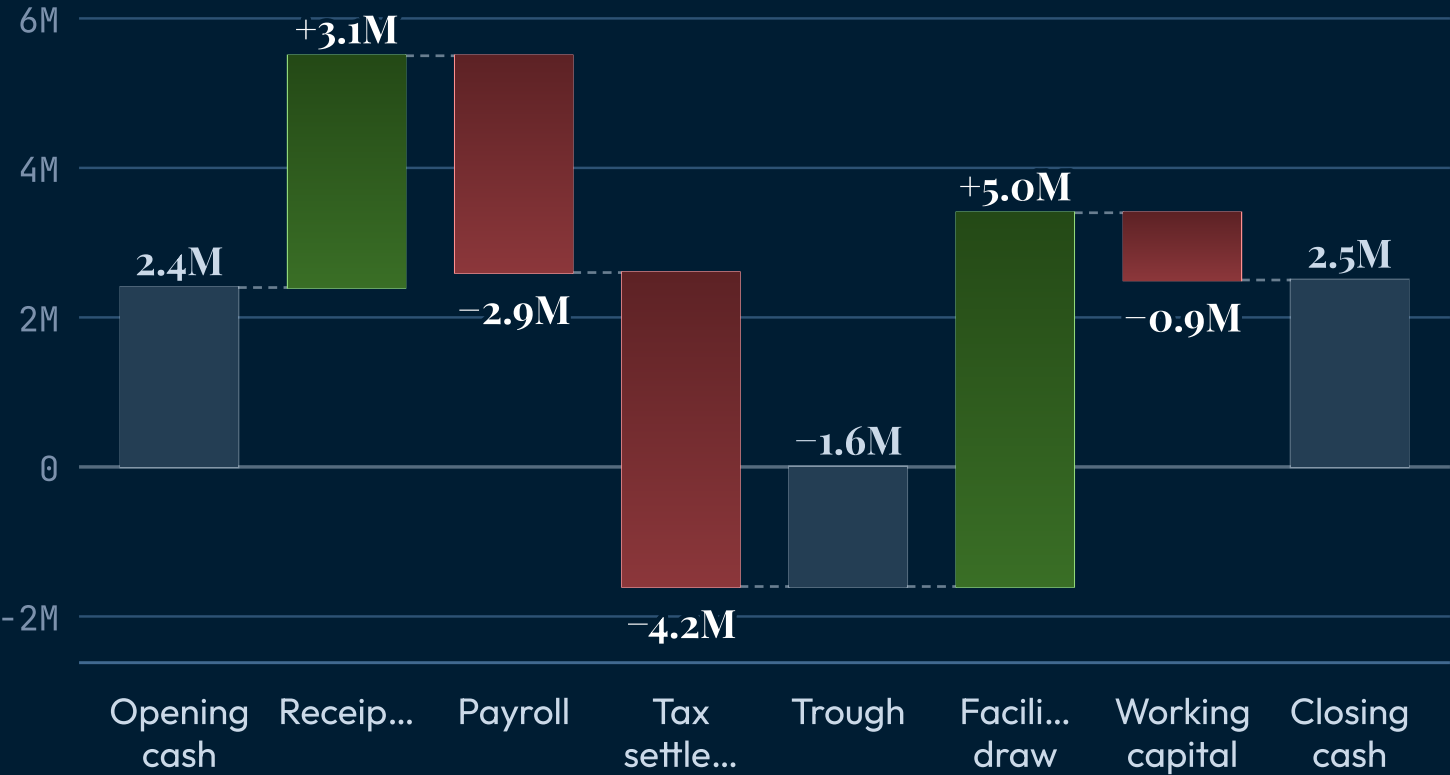
A bridge from one total to another through signed contributions, each bar starting where the last one ended.

FY26 PLAN · ACTUAL

Price paid for the volume we lost.



The quarter we went negative and came back.



FY26 PLAN · ACTUAL

Price paid for the volume we lost.



FY26 PLAN · ACTUAL

Price paid for the volume we lost.



FY26 PLAN · ACTUAL

Price paid for the volume we lost.



When NOT to reach for waterfall.

Independent magnitudes with no running total

Revenue by region, spend by department, five metrics side by side — nothing accumulates, so the floating geometry is a lie. Use `bar`.

Parts of one total, all positive

A decomposition where every contribution is a positive share of one whole is a stack, not a walk: use `stacked-bar`, or `piechart` if there is only one total. A waterfall's whole apparatus — the sign, the two semantic hues, the connectors — buys you nothing when nothing goes down.

A monotonic pipeline that narrows

Visitors to signups to paid is a subset at every stage, not a set of signed contributions. Use `funnel`, whose taper IS the conversion rate.

Drivers that are 1% of the anchors

A walk from 12.0M to 11.9M via steps of 20k gives you two full-height anchors and a row of hairlines. The chart is not wrong, but the picture says 'nothing happened' — which may be the finding, in which case say it in a `big-number`, or drop the anchors and plot the drivers alone as a

See also.

`bar` — the categories are independent magnitudes with no running total, or you want the drivers alone without the anchors

`stacked-bar` — the contributions are all positive parts of one total rather than signed changes to it

`funnel` — each stage is a subset of the one before and the drop-off rate is the story

`big-number` — the net movement is the whole point and the drivers are not worth a slide

`line` — the total moved over time and you want the shape of the path, not the attribution